



HP Elitebook Ultra G1q 14

A Promising Start for Windows on ARM

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Here, we're diving into the HP EliteBook Ultra G1q 14, a business-oriented laptop powered by the Snapdragon X Elite X1E-78-100 SoC. Equipped with 16 GB of LPDDR5x-8400 soldered RAM and a 512 GB SSD, this machine retails for ₹1,69,934. Currently, it's available in a single configuration, but a related model, the OmniBook X 14, offers similar specs at a more consumer-friendly price.

You also have the HP AI Companion tool that comes with the laptop. This comes with several AI features, which we'll get to further in our review. Speaking of which, let's get started!

Build and Design

The EliteBook Ultra boasts a premium look, crafted from recycled aluminium and plastics. Its design echoes the AMD-powered Dragonfly Pro, with sim-

ilar aesthetics, hinge mechanics, and keyboard layout. While this gives the Qualcomm-powered device a sophisticated appearance, the small hinges are a weak point leading to noticeable wobbling when adjusting the lid.

However, the EliteBook Ultra shines in terms of size and weight, being thinner and lighter than many rivals.

In terms of connectivity, the EliteBook Ultra includes a USB-A port, which is a rarity in 14-inch notebooks. It also supports USB4, which further enhances compatibility opening up accessibility to docking stations and external monitors.

The keyboard layout closely resembles that of the Dragonfly Pro, with similar key sizes and fonts. However, the key travel feels pretty shallow. We would have appreciated stronger feedback; it would have gone a long way in

enhancing the overall typing experience. The keys are backlit which is great for use in dimly lit environments.

Coming to the touchpad, it is slightly on the larger side, which is great. This provides a larger area for multi-touch gestures. Tracking is smooth, and click feedback is firm and satisfying.

Wrapping up with communication options, the laptop features FastConnect 6900 for Wi-Fi 6E and Bluetooth 5.3. However, it does not support Wi-Fi 7, which may be a consideration for future-proofing your connectivity needs.

Display

The display on the HP Elitebook Ultra offers close to full sRGB colour coverage with a sub-QHD resolution of 2,240 x 1,400p, but it lacks advanced features like HDR support and higher refresh rates.

During our testing, we got a peak average brightness of just 281 nits. Colour accuracy however is great, like we mentioned above. We tested 99.8 percent sRGB coverage and 76.2 percent DCI-P3 coverage. You can certainly use this laptop for your media editing needs while on the go.

Performance

With that, we come to the performance. We've been pretty excited to see how the new Snapdragon X Elite processors perform ever since they were first announced. Of course, with these laptops being ARM-based machines, it meant that a lot of benchmarks weren't compatible. Options were limited, with a select few benchmarks having updates that work with ARM machines.

Starting things off with CPU benchmarks. We ran Cinebench 2024, Cinebench R23 and Geekbench 6 to measure single and multi-core performance.

As you can see, the scores are pretty solid, comparable to Intel Core Ultra 5/7 processors in terms of performance.

We used 3DMark to test the integrated Adreno GPU and as far as synthetic benchmarks scores go these are pretty good for an integrated GPU. You could easily play older AAA